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Almond Tree Gallery Artists

Mary Dillon

Mary Dillon is originally from Kilkenny, but moved to Roscrea in 1984. Mary has no formal training in art but has been painting for as long as she can remember. She first exhibited her work during Kilkenny Arts Week at the age of thirteen. More recently the Bank of Ireland have added her work to their art collection, and five of her paintings belong in the OPW art collection. Her paintings now belong in many prestigious public and private art collections, including The Hodson Bay Hotel, Athlone, The Malton Hotel, Killarney, The Hibernian Hotel, Kilkenny, and Áras an Uachtaráin.



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Emma Barone

Emma Barone was born in Tullamore, Co. Offaly. She spent many years studying & working in the areas of animation, interior, graphic & jewellery design, as well as stained glass, mosaic, architectural ceramics, visual merchandising & now also works as a kitchen designer. Two of her commissioned paintings are in the World Trade Centre Amsterdam. She has enjoyed much acclaim for her work in recent years and has participated in both solo and group shows with much success.



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Gill Bickerstaff

Gill Bickerstaff graduated from Birmingham Art College in 1963 and has exhibited her work extensively through out Great Britain and Ireland ever since. She moved to Ireland in 2001. "Ireland has made me appreciate the colour green. It ranges from deep blue/green to singing golden/green. It alters in seconds as the inevitable clouds and showers pass over. Lawrie and I lived for a year in the magical Glen of Aherlow. Later building a house and studio overlooking the Comeragh Mountains and Sliabh na mban." In 2005 Gill exhibited in The Narrow Space Gallery, Clonmel. Her work is collected internationally. She has work in the collection of, The Irish Consulate Edinburgh, The Bank of Ireland, Credit Union Offices, Ireland.



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Michelle Boyle

Michelle Boyle has been painting professionally for five years from her studio in Virginia, Co. Cavan. Her academic background is in landscape architecture and archaeology, which possibly informs her choice of artistic subject as Michelle is predominantly a landscape painter. Her work is defined by a commitment to line observation both with paint and pencil. More recently she is exploring figure



drawing and received an Arts Council bursary in 2007 to the Tyrone Guthrie Centre as part of this process.

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Siobhan Bulfin

Artist Siobhan Bulfin is renowned for her dynamic bronze sculptures. Siobhan's life revolves around horses. Alongside her husband she breaks and trains them. This depth of knowledge and understanding of horses is evident in her striking bronze sculptures. Horses in action are her favourite subjects. Her work belongs in many prestigious private and public collections both in Ireland and abroad



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Jerry Cahir

Jerry Cahir lives in Roscrea. He expresses his creativity in varied mediums including painting and sculpture "My work may be considered work in progress – a continuum. It is a journey, which started some years ago with the desire to know self, thus allowing the subjective aspects to manifest – free from the constraints of conformity".



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Caroline Conway

Caroline Conway lives in Birr, Co. Offaly she graduated from Edinburgh College of Art in 1991 winner of the Watt medal for best graduating design student. She has since exhibited in Great Britain and Ireland and has work in the collections of Offaly Co. Council and the O.P.W. Caroline has been involved in many Community Arts projects including the 2000 Percent for Art Halting Site Project. In 2006 she was granted a studio bursary by Offaly Co. Council for Belmont Mill.



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Cassandra Darlington

Having studied and worked in the thoroughbred industry for a number of years, Cassandra Darlington's interest in animals and passion for horses has now been channeled into her love of art. Her knowledge of animals is gained from hands-on experience; this is evident in the precision and detail that is a trademark of her work. Her work is much sought after and she is quickly being acknowledged as one of the foremost animal artists in this country.



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James Flack

James H. Flack has been painting since his early childhood in County Armagh. At 10, young James Flack was one of the youngsters whose paintings were chosen for display in a children's art exhibit that was a feature of the 1951 Festival of Britain. Flack initially trained for a career in the Presbyterian ministry, though his love of paintings never diminished. He holds the degrees of BA, BD, M.Th., and H.Dip.Ed. from Trinity College Dublin and Edinburgh University. He now devotes himself full-time to painting and teaching art in Athy, County Kildare. Flack exhibits regularly at galleries and in one-man shows in Ireland, Britain, Canada and the United States. His paintings have been purchased by libraries, museums, business concerns and private collectors in Ireland, Britain, Continental Europe, the United States, Canada, Australia and Africa.



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Brenda Harris

Brenda Harris was born in Dublin. She has recently moved from Wicklow to West Waterford. Coming from a family background of textile and fashion designers, a career she followed in the 70s, has kept her in close contact with colour and creativity. It wasn't until she moved to Co. Wicklow in 1980 and influenced strongly by the natural beauty of the area, she focused more on painting. A full time artist for the past fifteen years, she paints mainly in oil and watercolours. Her paintings have been featured on numerous television programs both in Ireland and the U. K. and she exhibits regularly in both solo and group shows throughout Ireland. Her work hangs in private and corporate collections in Ireland, US, UK, Germany, France and the Middle East. Brenda regularly hosts workshops and tutorials both in Ireland and France.



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Karen Hendy

Karen Hendy is a visual artist, who works in Stradbally. She is a graduate from the National College of Art and Design and she also studied at the Burren College of Art.. Her style can be described as in between figurative and abstract. She uses materials such as charcoal, pencil, inks, acrylic paint and oils. Her creation process is very physical and involves tearing, pulling, scraping, scratching and mark making. Some of the themes in her work are inter-human relationships, spirituality, emotions like fear, pleasure and aggression and nature in all its forms and beauty. Karen exhibited in the Royal Ulster Academy in 2007 and has recently completed a residency in the Cill Rialaig Arts Project in Co. Kerry.



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Richard J Gough

Richard lives near Nenagh in Co. Tipperary. He is a self taught artist who loves working with bog oak. When possible he seeks to develop the natural shapes already present in the wood trying to get a balance and flow into the finished pieces. He has exhibited in Kenny's Gallery, Galway An Damhlann, An Spideal, Gleeson's Gallery, Thurles and at many other venues and has work in many public and private collections.



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Ella Kavanagh

Ella Kavanagh graduated with a B.Ed (Hons) degree in 1982. She later chose to pursue a professional career in fine art after attending painting classes with Eoin de Leastar. Since then, Ella has exhibited extensively in both solo and group-shows throughout Ireland and internationally. Venues include the Origin Gallery and the Brown Gallery, both in Dublin, together with the Lavit Gallery in Cork, the Dyehouse Gallery in Waterford, the Collyer-Bristow Gallery, London the Okarina Gallery in Slovenia, the Galleria D'Arte in Paris and the Ganggalerie der Stadwerke in Austria. She has also exhibited works during the Royal Hibernian's Annual Exhibitions. She has also been selected to work at the Old Lyme residency in Connecticut in 2006, together with the Florence Biennale and in selected shows in Georgia, USA and Barcelona towards the end of 2005.



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Jock Nichol

Born in Scotland in 1962, Jock trained at Edinburgh College of Art, gaining a BA Hons in Drawing and Painting and a Post Graduate Diploma with Distinction. He has been awarded residencies at Hospitalfield, Arbroath, the Tyrone Guthrie Centre, and Cill Rialig, Ballinskelligs. Jock moved to Ireland in 1992 and has work in many collections in the UK, Ireland, USA and Canada. Jock presented a solo exhibition in Almond Tree Gallery in August 2008



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Donal O Braonain

Donal O Braonain is better known as Danny to his family and friends. Danny attended the National College of Art and Design, of which he is an associate member (ANCAD) winning the coveted NCAD prize in the history of Art and Design. Danny's childhood spent on the Barrow is one of the sources of his love of boats and his translucent river scenes show his love of light and reflections. Danny has been painting in a variety of media for over 40 years- watercolours and



bamboo being a particular favourite.. Danny's work hangs in Banks and Corporate Offices and in numerous houses throughout Ireland and abroad. Danny has exhibited with the Mill Studio (a founder member) in the College of Surgeons, The New Park Hotel and in the Talbot Hotel, Wexford, during the Festival of Opera.

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Gwyn Wallace

A student of Photography with The Open College of The Arts her interests mainly lie in natural history, portraiture and photojournalism. Greatly influenced by the beauty in simple things she keeps her style contemporary as she explores the magnificence of the lisanthus . In December 2007 an exhibition of her photographs entitled 'Colourful' was held in Roscrea library



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Heidi Wickham

Born in 1966 in Abergavenny, South Wales she graduated from West Surrey College of Art and Design with a BA (Hons) in Fine Art. She moved to Sligo fifteen years ago where she now lives with her husband and two sons .She has been working in charcoal for about four years. She has had four solo exhibitions in Sligo and has exhibited in group shows in the Dock Gallery, Carrick on Shannon, in the Teach Ban Nua Gallery, Drumcliffe,Sligo and in the Greenlane Gallery, Dingle ,Co. Kerry



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Rita Wobbe

Born in Germany, Rita Wobbe has lived in the Burren, Co. Clare for nearly twenty years. Her sculptural abstract works explore the colours and textures of nature, either in the landscape around her or from her travels abroad. She has had numerous solo shows in the west of Ireland, at the RHA's Ashford Gallery, and in the Netherlands and Germany. Her work is in major Irish public collections, and in private collections in Ireland, Europe and the US.



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